HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Gas Testing

Document Guide 02 | Issue 5 | Owner: Permit Office | Review cycle: every twelve months

1. What this guide covers

This guide covers gas testing: the gas test before the work and its readings - flammable gas in percent of the lower explosive limit, oxygen in percent, hydrogen sulphide and carbon monoxide in ppm - the detector used, monitoring while the work goes on, and testing again. It fills the gas test record and appears in method statements for hot work and confined space entry.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- a flammable gas reading, written as a number and % LEL
- an oxygen reading, written as a number and % oxygen
- a toxic gas reading, written as a number and ppm hydrogen sulphide or ppm carbon monoxide
- the detector used and its calibration, and where in the space the test was taken
- continuous monitoring during the work, and a test again after a break or before re-entry

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the request's gas readings: flammable gas and oxygen, and for an entry the toxic gases.

2 Read each reading written N% LEL, N% oxygen, N ppm hydrogen sulphide or N ppm carbon monoxide.

3 Compare each reading with the request's reading of the same gas, as an exact decimal.

4 Flag the sentence DESCRIBES BLANK ANSWER where the request left that gas blank, else DISAGREES WITH FORM where a reading differs.

5 Check the test was taken at the work point, and inside a space at more than one level.

4. Requirements it bears on

Gas testing bears on the flammable gas and oxygen requirements of the hot work and confined space entry standards, and on the hydrogen sulphide and carbon monoxide requirements of the confined space entry standard.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

A flagged sentence never changes the request's answer, which still decides the requirement. The flag is for the Area Authority, and a request returned to its requester asks for the request and the gas test record to be settled.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority for the gas test record from the work point, and from inside a space at the top, middle and bottom, with every reading in the units the standard states and the detector's calibration.

7. Telling it apart

Testing the atmosphere is gas testing; the standby person, the rescue plan and the equipment to bring an entrant out are rescue, which the Rescue guide covers. "The atmosphere is tested before every entry" is gas testing; "the standby person keeps count of who is inside" is rescue, even when the standby person also watches the gas monitor.